

Employment Contract

THIS AGREEMENT is made and entered on the signed date below by and between TopTech Informatics K.K., hereinafter referred as the “Company” and Kranthi Kumar Kandula, hereinafter referred as the “Employee”.

WHEREAS Employee has experience and expertise in software engineering, and has advised the Company of their willingness, ability and desire to provide services to the Company in the above areas and on an exclusive basis and as of the activation date is no longer in the employment of any other.

NOW THEREFORE, it is hereby agreed as follows:

Agreement

1. Company hereby engages Employee and Employee hereby to make themselves available to render advisory and consulting services under the terms and conditions set forth herein.

The term of this Agreement shall be from September 1, 2026 to August 31, 2027 and may be extended by an agreement between the parties. Where the Company does not intend to renew this Agreement upon its expiry, the Company shall provide the Employee with written notice of non-renewal no later than thirty (30) days prior to the expiry date of this Agreement. Failure to provide such notice shall not automatically result in renewal but shall entitle the Employee to thirty (30) days' average wages in lieu of such notice. Employee shall be placed under probation for a period of six months from the date of employment. If the Employee is found unsuitable at any point during or at the conclusion of the probationary period, the Company reserves the right to terminate this contract, by providing at least thirty (30) days' prior written notice, citing specific grounds for termination as set forth in this contract. The Company shall conduct a formal performance evaluation and communicate the outcome in writing to the Employee, confirming either: (a) Successful completion of the probationary period and continuation of employment for the remainder of the fixed term, or (b) Termination of the contract with thirty (30) days' written notice. However, during the probationary period, Company may terminate this contract during the initial fourteen (14) days from the date of joining without notice or payment in lieu. Successful completion of the probationary period does not guarantee renewal of this contract beyond its fixed term.

2. Employee agrees to make themselves available to render services to the Company or its clients with respect to their experience and expertise and to give advice and suggestions to the Company or its clients as may be requested from time to time by Company or its clients.

4. Employee further agrees that during the term of this Agreement, not to engage in any further business activity, or to perform any services for their own account, or to be employed by any third party, without obtaining pre-approval from Company.

5. Employee shall devote themselves to the services hereunder during the regular office hours of Company or its clients.

Compensation

6. Employee shall receive as compensation for the performance of all services hereunder a gross sum of ¥ 822,500 per month, subsequently. Applicable Japanese withholding and relevant taxes and any other statutory deductions (Employee Pension, Health Insurance, Workers Accident Insurance, Employment Insurance, etc.) will be deducted from this compensation.
7. Commutation and Reimbursements: The Gross Base Salary specified under this Agreement represents the Employee's fixed cash compensation for services rendered. Any commuting or transportation expenses, allowances, reimbursements, or other benefits shall be provided, if applicable, strictly in accordance with the Company's applicable policies (including its global reimbursement/expense policy), as amended from time to time. Such amounts shall not form part of the Gross Base Salary unless expressly stated otherwise.

7. Payment of any expense reimbursement approved as in clause 9 and any overtime, shall be made to the bank account designated by Employee after payment by Company's customer for whom the Employee performed the services. Payment of monthly salary and commuting allowance shall be made no later than the last working day of the month. All overtime work must be approved in advance by the reporting manager. Overtime allowances may be paid in cash or an equivalent time off in lieu. 22 hours of overtime is included in the base salary.

8. Employee shall be entitled to have appropriate paid vacation and sick leave as mentioned in the *Employee Vacation* document, calculated on a pro-rata basis for the term of this Agreement. Employee is eligible to use the vacation days at any reasonable time after the completion of six months of employment.

9. Subject to pre-approval, Employee shall be reimbursed for all reasonable business expenses incurred by Employee on behalf of Company in the performance of services hereunder, upon compliance with the then policies of Company relating to reimbursement of such expenses. Employee is required to obtain pre-approval of such expenses and submit itemized requests for reimbursement of such expenditures supported by sufficient documentation of the expenditures and explanations of their purpose.

Background Screening

10. Company may conduct background screening of the Employee, in accordance with industry best practices and to the extent possible under the applicable law, prior to the Employee joining Company or anytime during the employment term. The background screening can be initiated by Company on its own volition or as required by customers of Company as part of the on-boarding process at the customer site. Company reserves its right to exclude/terminate immediately Employee due to any deficiency in the background screening so conducted. The background screening shall include but not be limited to the following requirements:

- Identity check
- Criminal Check (for up to 10 years)
- Global watchlist / Global sanctions , database & OFAC
- Highest Graduated Education
- Previous Employment (for up to 10 years)
- Credit History (as per local laws)
- Address Check (for up to 10 years or last 5 addresses)

The above list is not an exhaustive list and is subject to variation and additions in accordance with the local jurisdictional laws. Employee agrees that in the event the result of background check conducted as per this clause is found to be unsatisfactory in the sole discretion of the Company and/or its customer, Company shall terminate this contract with immediate effect. Company shall not be held liable for any remuneration, claims, fees, damages, losses, liabilities, expenses, costs or consequences of the Employee.

Termination

11. Notwithstanding the term of this Agreement, this contract may be terminated as follows:

10.1 By either party giving to the other not less than one month's notice in writing or payment in lieu thereof by the party initiating the action.

10.2 By Company at any time without notice or payment of compensation, if Employee is guilty of dishonesty, willful misconduct or gross negligence.

10.3 Due to unsatisfactory reports from the Background Screening.

12. Without prejudice to the generality of the foregoing, the Company reserves the right to terminate your employment for any "unavoidable reasons" in accordance with the Rules of Employment. "Unavoidable Reasons" for termination includes without limitation, where:

- (ii) you materially breach this Agreement or the Company's Rules of Employment;
- (iii) it is determined that you lack the necessary ability to carry out your duties specified in this Agreement;

- (iv) negligence on the job leads to poor performance;
- (v) demonstrates unsatisfactory work performance, including negligence on the job or poor output;
- (vi) you often arrive to work late, leaves work early, absent yourself from work or makes requests for time off with little advance notice without a proper cause and it is determined that your work performance is insufficient;
- (vii) you fail to fill a specific position, performing a specific type of work, or possess a certain ability, upon which your engagement was contingent;
- (viii) you become subject to a serious disciplinary action or commits serious violation of internal rules;
- (ix) you become subject to a minor disciplinary action or commits a slight violation of internal rules but shows no sign of repentance, repeats the violation, or is determined to have no prospect of improvement;
- (x) is considered unqualified for continued employment during or at the conclusion of the probationary period
- (xi) negatively influences the work performance or conduct of other employees;
- (xii) you commit an unlawful act;
- (xiii) you are determined to have no competence as an employee of the Company;
- (xiv) continuing the business of the Company becomes impossible due to a natural disaster or a force majeure event;
- (xv) the Company determines to downsize, restructure, or reduce its workforce for business reasons, or for any other sufficient reason for dismissal.;
- (xvi) the credentials, personal and professional information such as your resume, previous employment and compensation details, education information or any such information that you furnished are found to be false at any time;
- (xvii) other sufficient reasons for dismissal of you other than the foregoing exist.

13. Notwithstanding any other provision of this Agreement, during the first fourteen (14) days from the Employee's date of joining, the Company reserves the absolute right to terminate this contract immediately and without any obligation whatsoever, including without limitation, any prior notice, notice pay, dismissal notice allowance, compensation, or payment in lieu, in accordance with Article 21 of the Labor Standards Act of Japan. The Employee shall have no claim against the Company in respect of such termination.

Confidentiality

13. Employee shall agree and sign the *Employee Confidentiality Agreement* and *Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA) Agreement*.

Staff Regulations

14. Company shall be entitled at any time and from time to time to promulgate and amend staff regulations not inconsistent with the terms of this Agreement as from time to time varied, which staff regulations and any amendments thereto shall be notified in writing to each employee and shall thereupon become legally binding.

Others

15. This Agreement is between Company and Employee, and neither party shall may sell, assign, transfer or hypothecate any rights or interests created under this Agreement or delegate any of their duties without the prior written consent of the other, provided that Company may assign this Agreement to an affiliated company or client. Any such delegation of either party hereunder without such consent shall be void.

16. The provision of Section 13 shall survive any termination or expiration of this Agreement.

17. This Agreement is subject to Employee's having work permit for Japan and having cleared a background check mandated by Company.

18. Non-Solicitation. During the term of this Agreement and for a period of one (1) year following the termination or expiration of this Agreement for any reason, the Employee shall not, directly or indirectly, solicit, approach, or attempt to divert any business from any customer, client, business partner, supplier, or prospective customer of the Company with whom the Employee had dealings, received Confidential

Information about, or came into contact with in the course of performing services under this Agreement. Furthermore, during the same period, the Employee shall not, directly or indirectly, solicit, induce, or encourage any employee, Employee, or consultant of the Company to terminate or reduce their engagement with the Company. This clause shall survive the termination or expiration of this Agreement.

19. Non-Compete. During the term of this Agreement and for a period of six (6) months following the termination or expiration of this Agreement for any reason, the Employee shall not, without the prior written consent of the Company, directly or indirectly engage in, carry on, or be employed, engaged, or interested in any capacity (whether as an employee, consultant, advisor, director, partner, investor, or otherwise) in any business or activity that is in competition with the business of the Company or its affiliates in any jurisdiction in which the Company operates or has operated during the Employee's engagement. During the term of this Agreement, the Employee shall exclusively devote their professional efforts to the Company and shall not engage in any other business activity without the prior written consent of the Company. This clause shall survive the termination or expiration of this Agreement.

20. Intellectual Property and Work Product Assignment. The Employee hereby irrevocably assigns to the Company all rights, title, and interest in and to any and all inventions, discoveries, developments, improvements, software, code, designs, drawings, works of authorship, trade secrets, and other intellectual property (collectively, "Work Product") conceived, created, developed, or reduced to practice by the Employee, alone or jointly with others, in the course of performing services under this Agreement or using the Company's resources, equipment, or Confidential Information. Such assignment includes all copyright, patent, trade secret, and other intellectual property rights worldwide. The Employee agrees to execute any documents and take any steps necessary to give full effect to this assignment. To the extent any Work Product qualifies as a work made for hire under applicable law, it shall be deemed a work made for hire owned by the Company. Any rights which cannot be assigned by operation of law are hereby licensed to the Company on an exclusive, royalty-free, worldwide, irrevocable basis. No additional compensation shall be payable to the Employee for such assignment except as may be required by the Patent Act of Japan (特許法) with respect to employee inventions. This clause shall survive the termination or expiration of this Agreement.

21. Anti-Social Forces Declaration. The Employee represents, warrants, and covenants that they are not, and will not at any time during the term of this Agreement become, a member, associate, or related party of any organized crime group (暴力団), organized crime group member (暴力団員), quasi-member, affiliated company, extortionist (總會屋), social movement-type extortionist, or any other person falling within the equivalent category under the Act on Prevention of Unjust Acts by Organized Crime Group Members of Japan or any applicable ordinance (collectively, "Anti-Social Forces"). The Employee further warrants that they have no relationship with Anti-Social Forces and will not engage in or facilitate any transaction or interaction with Anti-Social Forces during or after the term of this Agreement. Breach of this clause shall constitute grounds for immediate termination without notice or compensation.

22. Governing Law and Jurisdiction. This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of Japan. The parties hereby irrevocably submit to the exclusive jurisdiction of the Tokyo District Court (東京地方裁判所) or the Tokyo Summary Court (東京簡易裁判所), as appropriate, for the resolution of any dispute arising out of or in connection with this Agreement.

23. Survival. The provisions of Clauses 13 (Confidentiality), 19 (Non-Solicitation), 20 (Non-Compete), 21 (Intellectual Property and Work Product Assignment), 22 (Anti-Social Forces Declaration), and 23 (Governing Law and Jurisdiction) shall survive the termination or expiration of this Agreement for any reason.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the parties hereto have executed this Agreement as of the date first below written.

Date : July 6, 2026

For TopTech Informatics K.K.

Employee

Biju Paul

Name : Biju Paul
Position : Chief Executive Officer

Name : Kranthi Kumar K

STATEMENT OF WORK

Based on the Agreement between TopTech Informatics K.K. and Kranthi Kumar Kandula dated July 6, 2026 and NON-DISCLOSURE AND NON-COMPETE AGREEMENT between the same parties, dated July 6, 2026.

1. Scope of Services

- Cloud & DevOps: Containerize applications using Docker Compose/Kubernetes and automate cloud deployments (AWS/Azure) using Terraform.
- Advanced Backend Architecture: Design microservices (MSA) with Clean Architecture principles. Implement Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers and clients.
- LLMOps & Evaluation: Implement evaluation frameworks (RAGAS, BLEU) to empirically test RAG performance. Build pipelines that monitor model hallucinations and quality.
- Observability: logs, metrics, traces, SLOs.
- Client Communication: Define technical requirements based on business needs and explain technical trade-offs to non-technical stakeholders.

2. Working Conditions

Employee Name: Kranthi Kumar Kandula

Employment type: Fixed Term Employment

Position: Lead Engineer

Your term of employment with the company will be from September 1, 2026 to August 31, 2027.

1. Renewal of contract

- ☐ The contract shall be automatically renewed.
- ☒ The contract may be renewed.
- ☐ The contract is not renewable.
- ☐ Others ()

2. Renewal of the contract shall be determined by the following factors:

- ☒ Volume of work to be done at the time the term of contract expires
- ☒ Employee's work record and work attitude
- ☒ Employee's capability
- ☒ Business performance of the Company
- ☒ State of progress of the work done by the employee

☐ Others ()

Work Location: The Company's office in c/o Level 17, World Trade center Building South Tower, 2-4-1 Hamamatsu-Cho, Minato-Ku, Tokyo 105-5117, Japan or a location as designated by the Company.

(Scope of change)

The Company may request the employees on domestic and/or overseas business trips as required by the business. The employees may not refuse such a request without a legitimate reason to be reviewed and approved by the Company.

Social Insurance: Employee Pension, Health Insurance, Workers Accident Insurance, Employment Insurance (Application Date – Date of joining the Company).

Standard working hours: Monday-Friday 9:00-18:00 (1 hour lunch break)

Holiday: Saturday, Sunday, and Japanese national holidays

Rate of Payment: 703,122 JPY per month (**Gross Salary:** 822,500 JPY per month)

Overtime Payment: All overtime work must be approved in advance by the reporting manager.

Fixed Overtime Allowance: 119,378 JPY per month (corresponding to the premium for up to 22 hours of overtime work per month). This allowance is payable regardless of whether the Employee actually works the included overtime hours. Overtime work exceeding the above hours will be paid separately at the statutory premium rates. Premiums for late-night work and statutory holiday work will be paid separately in accordance with Japanese law.

18:00-21:00 – 1.25x hourly rate

22:00-5:00 – 1.5x hourly rate

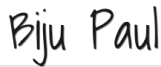
Weekend/holidays – 1.35x hourly rate

Bonus Payment: Up to 520,000 JPY per annum. Employee may be eligible for bonus payments at the sole discretion of the Company. Any such payments shall be contingent upon factors determined by the Company, including but not limited to performance, customer feedback, business conditions and other relevant factors.

Annual Paid leave: 10 days*

* The Employee shall be granted 1 day of paid leave per month during the first 6 months of continuous employment, with the remaining 4 days credited upon completion of the 6th month. Thereafter, paid leave shall be granted in accordance with applicable law.

Date: July 6, 2026

Signed in agreement by:	Signed in agreement by:
	
Biju Paul Chief Executive Officer	Kranthi Kumar Kandula
TopTech Informatics K.K.	